

# Femi Horrall

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## EDUCATION

### Northwestern University, Medill School of Journalism

Bachelor of Science in **Journalism** | Minor in **Data Science** | Certificate in **Design**

**Coursework:** Business of Journalism, Digital Product Development, Data Science 3 with R, Reporting in Rogers Park

**Evanston, Ill.**

*Expected June 2027*

### Bay Area Immersion Program

*Study away quarter*

**San Francisco**

*January 2025–March 2025*

**Coursework:** Visual Storytelling For The Web, UX Design, Bay Area Design Practicum, Intro to Data Journalism

**Industry Engagement:** Met with several media and tech companies (i.e. San Francisco Chronicle, Google, The Pudding)

## JOURNALISM/MEDIA EXPERIENCE

### The Daily Northwestern

*Social Media Editor*

**Evanston, Ill.**

*August 2026–Present*

- Posted scheduled and breaking social media content 3x/week; worked with Creative Director to redesign Instagram post template

*Web Developer*

*March 2026–June 2026*

- Built and designed two special issue webpages, working closely with design editors; added new Spanish section to website
- Recruited and led newspaper's first web team; documented coding guidelines and standards for future developers' reference

*Multimedia Managing Editor*

*December 2025–March 2026*

- Led and edited multimedia, socials and newsletter production (~20+ hours per week); managed 100+ editors and staff
- Facilitated record video, photo and audio output; organized multimedia trainings to help build newspaper's digital presence

*Data Visualizations Editor*

*August 2025–December 2025*

- Pitched, edited and published two+ graphics and stories per week using Flourish, Datawrapper and Python
- Made award-winning map of local ICE activity to support breaking coverage; edited 50+ visualizations for biannual poll

*Newsletter Editor*

*April 2025–June 2025*

- Sent daily newsletters and six breaking news alerts to 10,000+ subscribers, consistently driving open rates above 50%
- Designed three original special-edition newsletters, including advertisement for first-ever community engagement event

*Assistant City Editor*

*September 2024–December 2024*

- Wrote and published ~three articles per week (including 2 front page features) on local homelessness, public health and voting in the 2024 presidential election; produced breaking news coverage with turnaround times of three hours or less

### USA TODAY Co.

**Milwaukee**

*Content AI Intern*

*June 2026–August 2026*

- Designed company's first central library of approved AI tools and guidelines for thousands of reporters at 200+ US newsrooms
- Built a tool for the Milwaukee Journal Sentinel that scrapes Wis. campaign finance data and alerts reporters about major updates
- Interviewed 30+ journalists; tested 20+ AI tools for efficiency and adherence to journalistic standards; revised training materials

### Pittsburgh's Public Source

**Pittsburgh**

*Freelance Fact-Checker*

*September 2025–present*

- Fact-checked articles as-needed for nonprofit news organization with 45,000+ followers across platforms

*Editorial Intern*

*June 2025–September 2025*

- Pitched and wrote high-performing investigative, community-driven features, including the top story of September
- Fact-checked ~five features, made visualizations in Datawrapper and coordinated visuals with professional photographers

## SELECTED PROJECTS

### Medill: Reporting in Ghana

*September 2026*

- Conducted person-on-the-street interviews with non-English speaking coconut sellers at large markets; produced a video story

### Northwestern Knight Lab: Reimagining news on social media

*September 2025–December 2025*

- Analyzed Knight Lab/Financial Times Strategies data and 20+ user interviews to understand Gen Z's struggles with news on social media; presented solutions (AI news chatbot, algorithm "shuffle", etc.) and pitch deck to Knight Lab faculty

### Amazon Music: Platform community building

*January 2025–March 2025*

- Conducted 20+ user interviews and iterated on four social features aimed at improving Gen Z user acquisition and retention
- Designed high-fidelity Figma prototypes and presented them to ~15 execs at Amazon Music's San Francisco office

## AWARDS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

- [LIVE: A map of ICE activity in Evanston](#) – SPJ Regional 2025 Mark of Excellence Award winner
- Pitched and wrote Pittsburgh's Public Source's [top story of September 2025](#)
- Guest on [City Cast Pittsburgh](#) podcast to discuss article for Pittsburgh's Public Source in September 2025

## SKILLS

**Web/Data:** Flourish, Datawrapper, R, React, Python, Redbird | **Audience:** SEO, Mailchimp, Instagram, X, Bluesky, TikTok

**Design and Multimedia:** Figma, Adobe Creative Suite (Premiere Pro, Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign), Canva